NO. 1 ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES, *New Delhi*

BEST OF THE BEST

THE COUNTRY'S PREMIER MEDICAL INSTITUTE AIMS TO PROVIDE A HOLISTIC EDUCATION WITH EQUAL EMPHASIS ON SOFT AND TECHNICAL SKILLS BESIDES MEDICAL SKILLS



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Involve and innovate have been two guiding words for the All India Institute of Medical Sciences in the past academic year. The fallout of the pandemic can still be seen at the institute, with many parents still uncertain if they want their children to attend physical classes. As a result, faculty began to make the return to classrooms gradually, initially beginning with less frequent sessions. Maintaining a balance between online and offline teaching is key for the faculty here. "We took decisions about teaching keeping in mind the requirements and views of staff and students—and we innovated," says director Dr Randeep Guleria. "Some aspects of medical teaching—such as training on mannequins—need to have an offline aspect. And while we provided them with an online alternative during lockdown periods, from last year onwards, we had begun small batches of offline training as well." The institute's online teaching platform SARAL continues to operate alongside offline classes.

A post-pandemic student is likely to acquire new skills that those before Covid might not have had as much exposure to—training in infectious disease management, online classrooms and telemedical consultations. "Technology is merging more with medicine and so it is important for our students to be familiar with new advances. The